

Leon Kirkwood Reynolds

(1889-1963)

A documented biographical and genealogical research report

Prepared July 26, 2026

Born	December 9, 1889 Arcadia, Valley County, Nebraska
Known as	Kirk Reynolds; also L. Kirk Reynolds and Leon K. Reynolds
Married	Philomene Barnes March 3, 1921 Portland, Oregon
Son	Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds born April 7, 1932
World War I	Served in France without seeing combat (family testimony)
Career	Mortgage inspection; savings-and-loan leadership; FHA underwriting; Federal Home Loan Bank governance; First Federal presidency
Honolulu	Government bungalow near Royal Hawaiian; Kirk remained through December 7, 1941 (family testimony)
Died	June 11, 1963 pneumonia after fractured hip; Parkinson's disease (family testimony)
Buried	Clackamas Cemetery Clackamas County, Oregon

This report consolidates the information located to date about Leon Kirkwood Reynolds. It preserves established facts, family testimony, and promising unresolved clues while distinguishing evidence from inference.

The research subject is the grandfather of the person who requested this report. Family testimony identifies Daniel as Leon and Philomene's only child; records Leon's noncombat World War I service in France; and preserves details of the family's Honolulu residence, travel, and separation shortly before Pearl Harbor.

Research note: Historical directories and newspapers were often searched through optical character recognition. OCR errors are common. The absence of a search result is not proof that a person was absent.

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1. Principal findings

The available documentary evidence and explicitly identified family testimony support the following biographical profile:

- **Full name:** Leon Kirkwood Reynolds.
- **Names used publicly:** Kirk Reynolds, L. Kirk Reynolds, Leon K. Reynolds, and, in a cemetery transcription, Kirkwood Reynolds.
- **Birth:** December 9, 1889, in Arcadia, Valley County, Nebraska.
- **Move to Portland:** Approximately 1902, when Leon was about twelve or thirteen. His 1963 death notice said that he had moved to the Portland area 61 years earlier.
- **World War I:** Family testimony states that Leon served in France during World War I but did not see combat. His branch, unit, dates, and duties have not yet been documented. [S33]
- **Parents:** George W. Reynolds was identified as his father in Leon's wedding announcement. A 1920 directory lists George W. with a wife named Isabelle, making Isabelle Leon's probable mother. The biological relationship should still be verified with a census, birth record, or death certificate.
- **Sibling:** Irene H. Reynolds, a music teacher, was explicitly identified as Leon's sister and served as maid of honor at his wedding.
- **Marriage:** Leon married Philomene Barnes at 5:00 p.m. on March 3, 1921, at the Irvington home of her father, E. L. Barnes.
- **Only child:** Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds, born April 7, 1932, in Portland, was Leon and Philomene's only child according to family testimony. [S25, S33]
- **Philomene's earlier life:** Family testimony places Philomene first in Michigan, then in Spokane, and later in Portland. Her father, E. L. Barnes, had a sawmill in Spokane that burned down. [S33]
- **Occupation and career:** Mortgage-loan inspection, savings-and-loan association work, statewide industry leadership, Federal Housing Administration underwriting, Federal Home Loan Bank governance, and presidency of First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland.
- **Honolulu:** The family lived in a government bungalow very near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel and traveled between San Francisco and Honolulu by passenger ship. Philomene and Daniel returned to Portland shortly before December 7, 1941, while Leon remained in Honolulu. A 1940 directory independently lists Kirk as the FHA chief underwriter, residing at the Colonial Hotel. [S16, S33]
- **Death:** June 11, 1963, at Providence Hospital in Portland, aged 73. Family testimony states that Leon had Parkinson's disease, suffered a fractured hip, and died from pneumonia in the hospital. [S01, S33]
- **Burial:** Clackamas Cemetery in Clackamas County, Oregon, in the area transcribed as "Left of Road."
- **Wife's burial:** Philomene B. Reynolds is recorded beside or in the same cemetery area, with the years 1889-1988.

An especially important correction is that **1963 is Leon's death year**. The year 1988 belongs to Philomene. A secondary family-tree or index entry appears to have incorrectly attached Philomene's death year to Leon.

2. Evidence and confidence conventions

The report uses the following practical confidence categories:

- **Established:** Supported by a contemporary record that identifies Leon directly, or by two or more mutually reinforcing records.
- **Strongly supported:** The evidence is highly persuasive but a record uses an abbreviated name or omits one identifying detail.
- **Family testimony:** Information supplied by a direct descendant. Family testimony is valuable evidence, particularly for movements and experiences not recorded in directories, but it is identified separately from documentary confirmation.
- **Provisional clue:** A potentially useful lead that should not yet be treated as part of the proven family tree.

Historic directories and newspapers were frequently searched through optical character recognition. OCR errors are common, particularly with names in small type. The absence of a search result is therefore not evidence that a person was absent from a place.

3. Names and identity

The same individual appears under several forms:

- **Leon Kirkwood Reynolds** - the full name used in Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds's obituary and confirmed by the family.
- **Leon K. Reynolds** - the form used in the 1920 Portland directory.
- **Kirk Reynolds** - the overwhelmingly common professional and social form used in newspapers and later directories.
- **L. Kirk Reynolds** - the form used in the 1963 Oregonian death notice.
- **Kirkwood Reynolds** - the form in the Clackamas Cemetery transcription.

These variations explain why ordinary searches for "Leon Reynolds" initially missed many of the most informative records.

No middle name other than Kirkwood has been found. The evidence does not suggest that Leon and Kirk were different people. The continuity of spouse, address, occupation, relatives, and dates establishes that these are name variants for one man.

4. Birthplace and Nebraska background

Leon's death notice reports that he was born on **December 9, 1889, in Arcadia, Nebraska**. Arcadia is a village in Valley County in central Nebraska. The official Valley County website includes Arcadia among the county's communities. [S01, S28]

The precise Reynolds household in Arcadia has not yet been proven. A potentially significant but unresolved clue appears in the 1890 Nebraska State Gazetteer. Its Arcadia entries include:

- An **Isabel Reynolds**, identified as Mrs. and serving as postmaster.
- A **W. B. Reynolds**, involved in real estate and insurance.

These entries are intriguing because Leon was born in Arcadia in 1889 and his probable mother was later listed as Isabelle Reynolds. They are not sufficient to identify either person as Leon's parent or relative. In particular, Leon's 1921 wedding announcement names George W. Reynolds as his father. Possible explanations include unrelated Reynolds households, a remarriage or stepfamily, an initial or transcription problem, or a more distant family relationship. No one of these explanations should be adopted without census or vital-record evidence. [S29]

The 1963 death notice says Leon moved to the Portland area approximately 61 years before his death. Subtracting 61 years from 1963 places the move around **1902**. Leon would have been twelve, approaching thirteen. The wording suggests that his family, not Leon alone, made the move. [S01]

No reliable record of Leon's elementary or secondary school has been located. No college attendance has been established. His later technical expertise in mortgage inspection and underwriting could have resulted from formal education, professional training, work experience, or some combination, but the present evidence does not distinguish among those possibilities.

Family testimony states that Leon served in France during World War I but did not see combat. No draft card, service record, unit history, transport list, or other military document has yet been located. His service should therefore be preserved as family testimony while the branch, unit, rank, dates, duties, and reason for being in France remain subjects for documentary research. A World War I draft registration card would also be valuable because it should provide Leon's exact address, occupation, employer, physical description, and nearest relative between 1917 and 1918. [S33]

5. The Reynolds household in Portland

The 1920 Portland city directory provides the clearest early household record. At **950 East Davis Street**, it lists:

- George W. Reynolds, with wife Isabelle, employed as a salesman.
- Irene H. Reynolds, a music teacher.
- Leon K. Reynolds.

All were recorded at the same address. [S03]

The 1921 wedding announcements strengthen the household interpretation. They describe Leon as the son of Mr. and Mrs. George W. Reynolds of Portland. They also identify Irene Reynolds as Leon's sister. [S05, S06]

The combined evidence establishes:

- George W. Reynolds was Leon's father, or at minimum the man publicly identified as his father at the time of Leon's marriage.
- Isabelle was George's wife in 1920 and was probably Leon's mother.
- Irene H. Reynolds was Leon's sister.

The present evidence does not establish George's or Isabelle's birthplaces, ages, occupations before Portland, marriage date, or dates of death. Nor does it show whether Leon had additional siblings.

6. Philomene Barnes and the Barnes family

Philomene Barnes was born in 1889. The cemetery transcription records the years 1889-1988. A secondary genealogical index gives the more precise dates September 5, 1889, to March 30, 1988, but those exact dates have not yet been verified against an original death certificate, obituary, or Social Security record. They should therefore be treated as provisional. [S02, S30]

Philomene's father was **E. L. Barnes**, whose Irvington home was used for the 1921 wedding. Her brother was **Maurice H. Barnes**. Maurice's wife was **Geraldine Coursen Barnes**. [S05, S06]

Family testimony places Philomene first in **Michigan**, then in **Spokane, Washington**, and later in **Portland, Oregon**. It also states that her father, E. L. Barnes, had a sawmill in Spokane and that the sawmill burned down. The precise Michigan location, whether Michigan was her birthplace, the dates of the family moves, the sawmill's business name and location, and the date and circumstances of the fire have not yet been documented. Newspaper, city-directory, census, land, insurance, and business-license records may make this family memory independently traceable. [S33]

A 1913 society report placed E. L. Barnes and Miss Philomene Barnes at Hotel Bayocean. This helps establish Philomene's pre-marriage association with her father and Portland society. [S08]

An earlier 1907 newspaper item lists a Mrs. L. Barnes, Maurice Barnes, and Philomene Barnes among Portland visitors. The grouping is suggestive but does not safely identify Mrs. L. Barnes as Philomene's mother. [S08]

The current evidence does not establish Philomene's mother's full name, Philomene's precise birthplace, or her education. These details, and the Michigan-Spokane-Portland sequence, may appear on her 1988 death certificate, marriage license, obituary, or early census records.

7. Courtship, engagement, and wedding

Leon was socially associated with Philomene and her family by at least 1919. A Sunday Oregonian society notice includes Philomene Barnes and E. L. Barnes with a name OCR rendered as "Lem K. Reynolds." In context, this is probably a misreading of Leon K. or Kirk Reynolds. Because the image has not been independently transcribed at high resolution, the item is best treated as a strong but not absolute identification. [S08]

The engagement of Philomene Barnes and Kirk Reynolds was formally announced in February 1921. [S04]

They married at **5:00 p.m. on Thursday, March 3, 1921**, at the home of Philomene's father, E. L. Barnes, in Portland's Irvington neighborhood. The Rev. Edward H. Pence of Westminster Presbyterian Church officiated. [S05, S06, S07]

The wedding party and music included:

- **Irene Reynolds**, Leon's sister, as maid of honor.
- **Maurice H. Barnes**, Philomene's brother, as best man.
- **Geraldine Coursen Barnes**, Maurice's wife, playing the wedding march.

- **Madeline Stone**, singing.

Leon and Philomene received guests with E. L. Barnes and Mr. and Mrs. George W. Reynolds. After a wedding trip, the couple intended to make their home in Portland. [S05, S06]

The Oregon marriage index records the couple as:

- Reynolds, Leon K.
- Barnes, Philomene M.
- Year 1921, volume 51, page 230.

The middle initial M. in the index should be preserved as recorded, although later sources often use Philomene B., apparently treating Barnes as a middle or maiden-name initial. [S07]

In October 1922, Mrs. Kirk Reynolds was among the women presiding at the tea urns during a prominent Portland social event at the home of Mrs. Arch J. Tourtellotte. The hostesses were Laura and Mabel Korell. The other women presiding included Mrs. Neagle P. Sealy, Mrs. Harold Temple, and Mrs. Arthur Fender. The notice places Philomene in the city's social network shortly after her marriage. [S09]

8. Son: Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds

Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds was born in Portland on **April 7, 1932**, to Philomene Barnes Reynolds and Leon Kirkwood Reynolds. He died January 28, 2025. [S25]

Family testimony identifies Daniel as **Leon and Philomene's only child**. No contradictory evidence has been found. [S33]

Daniel attended Lincoln High School and graduated from the University of Oregon in 1955 with a Bachelor of Business Administration degree. He belonged to Delta Upsilon fraternity, participated in ROTC, and later served in the United States Army for eight years. [S25, S26]

After graduation, Daniel married **Norma Frances Crowley**. Their children, as named in Daniel's published obituary, were:

- Catherine Reynolds Mock.
- John Daniel Reynolds.
- Susan Reynolds Workman.

Daniel became a residential real-estate appraiser. The 1959 Portland directory specifically lists him as an appraiser for **Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan Association**, with a residence in Vancouver, Washington. Later, he formed his own appraisal company. In the 1980s he developed a commercial computer service that assembled and distributed residential-sales data across the Pacific Northwest. [S22, S25]

Daniel's career followed the same broad field as Leon's: housing finance, property analysis, appraisal, and mortgage-lending information. This intergenerational continuity is a documented family pattern rather than merely a coincidence of employer names.

Daniel's obituary also records his interests in amateur photography, a home darkroom, handcrafted slot-car tracks, humor, and sustained attention to the daily lives and goals of his children and grandchildren. [S25]

9. Early career in mortgage lending

1925: Equitable Savings and Loan

The first direct professional records located are from 1925.

On March 25, 1925, a Klamath Falls newspaper noted Kirk Reynolds of Portland in town on business. The brief item did not identify his employer. [S10]

On October 20, 1925, the Roseburg News-Review identified Kirk Reynolds as a representative of **Equitable Savings and Loan**, visiting from Portland on business. [S11]

Four days later, the Medford Mail Tribune described him more precisely as an **inspector of loans for the Equitable Savings and Loan Association**, spending several days in Medford on business. [S12]

These reports show that by age 35 Leon was traveling throughout Oregon to inspect or supervise mortgage loans. Loan inspection would have required judgment about property, collateral, valuation, construction, borrower risk, and compliance with association policy. It established the professional base for his later work in government underwriting.

Equitable Savings and Loan, First Federal Savings and Loan of Portland, and Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan were distinct institutions in contemporary federal listings. Similar institutional names and later acquisitions make it important not to merge their histories without evidence. [S23]

10. Depression-era savings-and-loan leadership

1932: Home Loan Bank advocacy

In October 1932, amid the Depression's mortgage and construction crisis, Kirk Reynolds and Ben Hazen returned from a statewide meeting of savings-and-loan officials. The Oregon Statesman reported their support for making the Home Loan Bank in Portland operational. Their position was that access to the bank would relieve pressure on local associations and allow building activity to resume. [S13]

This activity places Leon in a broader financial-policy role. He was not only evaluating individual loans; he was participating in efforts to stabilize the institutions that supplied home mortgages.

1933: Executive secretary of the Oregon association

In February 1933, the Oregon Statesman identified Kirk Reynolds as **executive secretary of the Oregon association of savings-and-loan organizations**. He was in Salem monitoring Senate Bill 119. The legislation would enable Oregon associations to become members of the Home Loan Bank and obtain cash for new loans by discounting mortgages already in their portfolios. [S14]

The practical issue was liquidity. An association might own sound mortgages but lack cash to make new loans or meet pressure from savers. Home Loan Bank membership offered a way to borrow against those mortgage assets. Leon's involvement shows a working understanding of both institutional finance and housing policy.

The reports do not establish whether his executive-secretary position was full-time, part-time, or concurrent with another employer.

11. Federal Housing Administration work

1935: Acting chief underwriter in Portland

A March 1, 1935 Oregon Statesman article identifies Kirk Reynolds as **acting chief underwriter for the Federal Housing Administration** in Portland. [S15]

He was communicating with the Salem Realty Board about an FHA real-property survey. Salem was to be the only Oregon city included in that 1935 survey. The work involved an inventory of real property and a detailed study of the local housing situation. Reynolds expected to travel from the Portland office before March 10 and indicated that local real-estate professionals might be asked to assist.

The position is significant for several reasons:

- It demonstrates federal housing responsibility soon after the FHA's creation under the National Housing Act of 1934.
- It shows advancement from private loan inspection to senior underwriting.
- It supplies a direct occupational bridge to the 1940 Honolulu directory.
- It places Leon at the intersection of appraisal, housing-market analysis, mortgage risk, and public policy.

The article uses the word "acting," so it should not be assumed that he already held the permanent Portland chief-underwriter title.

12. Honolulu, 1939-1941

Family testimony gives a more precise account of the Honolulu period. Leon, Philomene, and Daniel lived there for approximately two years before the United States entered World War II. Their home was described within the family as a **"government bungalow" very near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel**. The family traveled between San Francisco and Honolulu aboard passenger ships. [S33]

Shortly before the December 7, 1941 attack on Pearl Harbor, **Philomene and Daniel returned to Portland while Leon remained in Honolulu**. Leon was therefore still in Honolulu at the time of the attack. His later travel date and the circumstances of his return to Portland have not yet been established. This more detailed testimony corrects the earlier, less precise impression that the entire family returned together after the attack. [S33]

The strongest documentary corroboration is the 1940 Polk-Husted directory for Honolulu and the Territory of Hawaii. Page 533 contains an entry in the Reynolds alphabetical section for a **Kirk** who was **chief underwriter for the FHA** and resided at the **Colonial Hotel**. [S16]

The searchable snippet reads in abbreviated directory form:

Kirk, chief underwriter, FHA; residence Colonial Hotel.

This is a strongly supported identification of Leon because:

1. Kirk was the name Leon consistently used.
2. Leon was already documented as an FHA acting chief underwriter in Portland in 1935.
3. The family independently remembered his presence in Honolulu during the same period.
4. Mortgage underwriting and territorial FHA administration were natural extensions of his established career.

The possibility of an unrelated Kirk Reynolds simultaneously serving as an FHA chief underwriter in Honolulu is remote. Nevertheless, the directory omits "Leon" and "Kirkwood," so the report preserves the technical distinction between a conclusive full-name record and an overwhelmingly persuasive match.

The Colonial Hotel listing and the family memory of a government bungalow need not conflict. The directory could preserve temporary lodging, an initial residence, a mailing address, an address supplied at a different point in the assignment, or information collected before or after the bungalow residence. It does not prove that Philomene and Daniel lived at the hotel. The phrase "government bungalow" may describe federally supplied housing connected to Leon's FHA post, but that interpretation remains to be documented. [S33]

Exact-name searches in the 1940 directory did not locate Philomene or Daniel. This absence is not decisive:

- A spouse and minor child might not receive separate alphabetical entries.
- The family's household could have been recorded under an address section not visible through snippet search.
- Directory OCR and snippet indexing are incomplete.

The Library of Congress has a Honolulu telephone-directory compilation covering November 1938 through approximately fall 1941 or 1942. A partial OCR search did not locate Leon in the first directory segment; service rate limits prevented a complete page-by-page search during this research session. [S17]

The 1941 Polk-Husted Honolulu directory exists, but its Google Books copy is not searchable or previewable. Its Reynolds page remains an important target.

No passenger manifest, travel notice, employment order, government-housing record, or Portland return notice has yet been found. Therefore:

- **Presence in Honolulu in 1940:** strongly documented.
- **FHA chief-underwriter role:** strongly documented.
- **Approximately two-year family stay:** family testimony, highly consistent with the directory evidence.

- **Government bungalow near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel:** family testimony, not yet tied to a street address or housing record.
- **Passenger-ship travel through San Francisco:** family testimony, not yet tied to particular vessels or sailing dates.
- **Philomene and Daniel returned before December 7, 1941:** family testimony, not yet tied to a passenger manifest.
- **Leon remained in Honolulu during the attack:** family testimony, strongly consistent with the timing and purpose of his documented assignment. [S33]

The Honolulu assignment may have been one of the most consequential periods of Leon's career. As chief underwriter in a United States territory undergoing rapid military and civilian development, he would likely have evaluated or supervised mortgage-insurance risk under unusually active housing conditions. That description is a reasoned occupational interpretation, not a claim about specific projects.

13. Postwar and regional leadership

The present record has a gap between Leon's return from Honolulu and the early 1950s. Leon's exact return date, employer, and title during the 1942-1952 period have not yet been established.

1953: Federal Home Loan Bank director

The Housing and Home Finance Agency's annual report for calendar year 1953 lists **Kirk Reynolds** as a **Class C director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco**. [S18]

The Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco served a western regional network. Board membership demonstrates that Leon's professional standing extended beyond a single Portland association.

1955: Continuing bank participation

A March 1955 Eugene Register-Guard report again identifies Kirk Reynolds of Portland as a director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco. It places him at the annual stockholders' meeting and records agreement among participants that housing activity was rising. [S19]

Together, the 1953 and 1955 records show that the directorship was not merely a one-day appointment or mistaken directory entry.

14. First Federal Savings and Loan of Portland

The 1956 Portland directory identifies Kirk Reynolds as:

- President of **First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland**.
- Husband of Philomene B.
- Resident of **3635 SW Beaverton Avenue**.
- Telephone **CApitol 8-4524**. [S20]

The association's own directory listing also names Kirk Reynolds as president.

The 1957 Portland directory again lists Kirk and Philomene at 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue. [S21]

The 1963 Oregonian death notice describes Leon as the retired **president and manager of First Federal Savings and Loan Company**. The institutional wording is slightly different from the 1956 directory, but the identity and leadership role are clear. [S01]

The records do not yet establish:

- The year Leon joined First Federal.
- Whether he returned directly to First Federal after Honolulu.
- The date he became president.
- The date he retired.

- Whether First Federal used both "Association" and "Company" as formal names or whether the newspaper simplified the name.
-

15. Residences and addresses

The known addresses form a useful geographic chronology:

- **Circa 1902:** Arrival in the Portland area, exact address unknown.
- **1920:** 950 East Davis Street, Portland, with George W., Isabelle, and Irene Reynolds.
- **1956-1957:** 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue, Portland, with Philomene.
- **1959:** 2705 SE River Road, Milwaukie, Oregon, with Philomene.
- **1963:** Willamette Manor, as reported in the death notice.
- **Burial:** Clackamas Cemetery, Clackamas County.

The 1959 directory describes Kirk and Philomene as residing at 2705 SE River Road in Milwaukie. It separately lists Daniel K. Reynolds and wife Norma, with Daniel working as an appraiser for Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan and residing in Vancouver, Washington. [S22]

A search of the 1962 Portland directory did not locate an exact Leon or Kirk Reynolds entry. This should not be interpreted as evidence that he had already died. He died in 1963, and the omission may reflect residence outside directory boundaries, retirement living, timing, or OCR failure.

16. The Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan question

Family memory associates Leon with Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan. The documentary record found so far supports meaningful Benjamin Franklin connections but does not yet show Leon as a direct employee or officer of that institution.

Facts directly documented

- In 1925 Leon represented and inspected loans for **Equitable Savings and Loan**. [S11, S12]
- In 1932 Leon participated in statewide savings-and-loan work with **Ben Hazen**. [S13]
- A congressional history identifies Hazen as the original secretary-treasurer and manager, later president and chairman, of the Portland association that became Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan. [S24]
- In the 1950s Leon was president of **First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland**. [S20]
- In 1959 Leon's son Daniel was an appraiser for **Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan Association**. [S22]
- Contemporary federal lists treat Equitable, First Federal, and Benjamin Franklin as separate Portland institutions. [S23]

Best current interpretation

The family had an unquestionable Benjamin Franklin connection through Daniel, and Leon worked directly with Benjamin Franklin's senior leadership through the state savings-and-loan association and broader Home Loan Bank network. A direct Leon-Benjamin Franklin employment relationship remains possible but has not been located.

The family memory should not be discarded. It may preserve:

- A short or interim role omitted from the directories examined.
- Board, committee, consulting, or association work rather than ordinary employment.
- Leon's close collaboration with Ben Hazen.
- Daniel's long-term employment, later remembered as part of the family's shared savings-and-loan history.
- A later institutional relationship or succession not yet traced.

The next best sources are First Federal and Benjamin Franklin corporate minutes, employee publications, annual reports, trade-journal notices, and Leon's full obituary.

17. Death, funeral, and burial

The June 12, 1963 Oregonian death notice supplies the exact vital information. It identifies **L. Kirk Reynolds, age 73**, of Willamette Manor, and describes him as the retired president and manager of First Federal Savings and Loan Company. It reports that he died Tuesday at Providence Hospital. Since the notice appeared Wednesday, June 12, the death occurred on **June 11, 1963**. [S01]

Family testimony supplies the medical context absent from the available death notice preview. Leon had **Parkinson's disease**, suffered a **fractured hip**, and was hospitalized in Portland. He died from **pneumonia** in the hospital. The recollection supports a sequence of chronic Parkinson's disease, hip fracture, hospitalization, and fatal pneumonia, but it does not establish the clinical relationship among those conditions or their wording on the death certificate. [S33]

The notice states:

- Birth on December 9, 1889, in Arcadia, Nebraska.
- Arrival in the Portland area approximately 61 years earlier.
- A funeral scheduled for 11:30 a.m. Thursday at Finley's Morninglight Chapel.
- A private committal, with the visible preview cutting off part of the final wording.

Thursday was June 13, 1963.

The Clackamas Cemetery transcription records:

- **Reynolds, Kirkwood**, born 1889, died 1963.
- **Reynolds, Philomene B.**, born 1889, died 1988.
- Location: **Section "Left of Road."** [S02]

The cemetery's use of "Kirkwood" rather than Leon or Kirk explains another search difficulty. It also provides independent confirmation that Leon died in 1963 and that Philomene was the spouse who died in 1988.

The transcription provides years rather than exact dates and may reflect either grave markers or a cemetery survey. A cemetery office record or marker photograph could reveal the precise plot and marker wording.

18. Detailed chronology

1889

- December 9: Leon Kirkwood Reynolds born in Arcadia, Valley County, Nebraska. Established by the 1963 death notice.

Circa 1902

- Moves to the Portland area, apparently with family, at about age twelve. Derived from the death notice's statement that he had moved there 61 years before 1963.

World War I era, approximately 1917-1919

- Family testimony states that Leon served in France during World War I.
- He did not see combat.
- His branch, unit, rank, dates, duties, and travel route remain undocumented. [S33]

1919

- Probable social appearance with Philomene Barnes and E. L. Barnes. The newspaper OCR renders his name imperfectly.

1920

- Lives at 950 East Davis Street with George W. Reynolds, George's wife Isabelle, and Irene H. Reynolds.

February 1921

- Engagement to Philomene Barnes announced.

March 3, 1921

- Marries Philomene at 5:00 p.m. at E. L. Barnes's Irvington home.
- Rev. Edward H. Pence officiates.
- Irene Reynolds is maid of honor.
- Maurice H. Barnes is best man.
- Geraldine Coursen Barnes plays the wedding march.
- Madeline Stone sings.

October 1922

- Philomene, as Mrs. Kirk Reynolds, assists at a prominent Portland tea.

March 1925

- Kirk Reynolds of Portland visits Klamath Falls on business.

October 1925

- Identified in Roseburg as an Equitable Savings and Loan representative.
- Identified in Medford as Equitable's inspector of loans.

October 1932

- Returns from a state savings-and-loan meeting with Ben Hazen.
- Advocates operation of the Home Loan Bank in Portland to improve liquidity and revive building.

April 7, 1932

- Son Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds born in Portland.

February 1933

- Serving as executive secretary of the Oregon association of savings-and-loan organizations.
- Monitors legislation enabling Oregon associations to join the Home Loan Bank and borrow against existing mortgages.

March 1935

- Acting chief underwriter for the FHA's Portland office.
- Coordinates an FHA real-property and housing survey in Salem.

Approximately 1939-1941

- Family testimony places Leon, Philomene, and Daniel in Honolulu.
- They live in a government bungalow very near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel.
- They travel between San Francisco and Honolulu aboard passenger ships.

1940

- Honolulu directory lists Kirk Reynolds as FHA chief underwriter, residing at the Colonial Hotel.

Shortly before December 7, 1941

- Philomene and Daniel return from Honolulu to Portland.
- Leon remains in Honolulu. Exact travel date and vessel are not yet documented. [S33]

December 7, 1941 and afterward

- Leon is still in Honolulu when Pearl Harbor is attacked.
- His return date, vessel, and route to Portland remain undocumented. [S33]

1953

- Listed as a Class C director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco.

1955

- Still identified as a director of the San Francisco bank and participating in its annual stockholders' meeting.
- Daniel graduates from the University of Oregon with a B.B.A. and later marries Norma Frances Crowley.

1956

- President of First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland.
- Lives with Philomene at 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue.

1957

- Still living with Philomene at 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue.

1959

- Kirk and Philomene live at 2705 SE River Road in Milwaukie.
- Daniel is an appraiser for Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan.

June 11, 1963

- Leon dies at Providence Hospital in Portland, age 73.
- Family testimony states that he dies from pneumonia after suffering a fractured hip and that he had Parkinson's disease. [S33]

June 13, 1963

- Funeral scheduled at Finley's Morninglight Chapel.

1963

- Buried or memorialized at Clackamas Cemetery under the name Kirkwood Reynolds.

March 30, 1988

- Provisional exact death date for Philomene from a secondary index. The cemetery independently establishes only the year 1988.
-

19. Professional significance

Leon's career can be understood as a consistent progression through the institutions that financed American home ownership:

1. **Loan inspection:** He evaluated individual mortgage loans for Equitable.
2. **Industry administration:** He helped represent Oregon savings-and-loan associations during the Depression.
3. **Liquidity and institutional policy:** He advocated Home Loan Bank membership and access to funding secured by existing mortgages.
4. **Federal underwriting:** He became a senior FHA underwriter in Portland and apparently chief underwriter in Honolulu.
5. **Regional governance:** He served on the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco board.
6. **Executive leadership:** He became president and manager of First Federal Savings and Loan in Portland.

This was not a series of unrelated jobs. Each role involved the valuation, funding, insurance, regulation, or institutional management of residential mortgage credit.

Leon's Depression-era activity is particularly noteworthy. Savings-and-loan associations could hold valuable mortgages but still lack cash for new lending or withdrawals. The Home Loan Bank system provided a mechanism for turning eligible mortgage assets into institutional liquidity. Leon was participating in that transition while it was being implemented in Oregon.

His FHA role also placed him near the beginning of modern federally supported mortgage underwriting. The FHA was created in 1934; Leon was already acting chief underwriter in Portland in early 1935.

20. People directly associated with Leon

Immediate Reynolds family

- **George W. Reynolds:** Leon's father as identified in the wedding announcements; a salesman in the 1920 directory.
- **Isabelle Reynolds:** George's wife in the 1920 directory and Leon's probable mother.
- **Irene H. Reynolds:** Leon's sister; music teacher; maid of honor at Leon's wedding.
- **Philomene Barnes Reynolds:** Leon's wife; family testimony places her earlier life in Michigan and Spokane before Portland.
- **Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds:** Leon and Philomene's only child according to family testimony.
- **Norma Frances Crowley Reynolds:** Daniel's wife.

Barnes family and wedding circle

- **E. L. Barnes:** Philomene's father and host of the wedding; family testimony states that he had a Spokane sawmill that burned down.
- **Maurice H. Barnes:** Philomene's brother and best man.
- **Geraldine Coursen Barnes:** Maurice's wife and wedding pianist.
- **Madeline Stone:** Wedding singer.

- **Rev. Edward H. Pence:** Officiating minister of Westminster Presbyterian Church.

Professional associates

- **Ben Hazen:** Fellow Oregon savings-and-loan leader in 1932 and a central executive of Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan.
 - **Oregon savings-and-loan officials:** Leon represented their state association as executive secretary in 1933.
 - **Salem Realty Board members:** Potential local participants in the 1935 FHA property survey Leon was organizing.
 - **Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco directors and officers:** Leon's regional governance colleagues in the 1950s.
-

21. Information not yet established

The following questions remain open:

- Who were Leon's biological parents, with full names, dates, and birthplaces?
 - Was Isabelle Reynolds his biological mother, stepmother, or another relation?
 - What relationship, if any, connected Leon's household to Isabel Reynolds, the 1890 Arcadia postmaster, or W. B. Reynolds, the Arcadia real-estate and insurance businessman?
 - Did Leon have siblings besides Irene?
 - Where did Leon attend school in Portland?
 - Did he attend college or complete formal banking, appraisal, or underwriting training?
 - What was his occupation before 1925?
 - What branch, unit, rank, dates, and duties describe Leon's noncombat World War I service in France?
 - Do military transport, personnel, veterans', or draft records independently document that service?
 - What was Philomene's mother's name?
 - Where and when was Philomene born, and when did she live in Michigan, Spokane, and Portland?
 - What was the name and location of E. L. Barnes's Spokane sawmill, and when and under what circumstances did it burn?
 - What were the family's exact Honolulu arrival and departure dates?
 - On which passenger ships did they travel between San Francisco and Honolulu?
 - What was the address of the government bungalow near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel?
 - Was the Colonial Hotel a temporary or mailing address, and how did its directory listing relate to the bungalow?
 - On what date did Philomene and Daniel leave Honolulu, and on what date did Leon return after Pearl Harbor?
 - What specific territorial FHA projects or offices did Leon supervise?
 - What was Leon's employer between the return from Honolulu and the early 1950s?
 - When did he join, become president of, and retire from First Federal?
 - Did Leon ever work directly for Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan?
 - How does Leon's death certificate describe the pneumonia, fractured hip, and Parkinson's disease recalled by the family?
 - What survivor information and organizational memberships appeared in the complete obituary?
 - What is the exact cemetery plot, and what does the grave marker say?
-

22. Recommended next research steps

1. Obtain Leon's Oregon death certificate

Use:

- Name: L. Kirk Reynolds or Leon Kirkwood Reynolds.
- Date of death: June 11, 1963.
- Place: Providence Hospital, Portland, probably Multnomah County.
- Date of birth: December 9, 1889.

Because the death occurred more than fifty years ago, the record is outside Oregon's ordinary access restriction. The certificate should identify the informant, parents, parents' birthplaces, marital status, residence, occupation, cause of death, contributing conditions, funeral establishment, and burial place. It is the best single record for testing the family's recollection of pneumonia after a fractured hip in the setting of Parkinson's disease. [S27, S33]

2. Retrieve the complete Oregonian death notice

The June 12, 1963 page is indexed in the Oregonian Historical Archive. A Multnomah County Library card provides archive access. The complete notice may name Philomene, Daniel, Irene or other siblings, grandchildren, memberships, and the exact committal location. [S01, S32]

3. Search the 1900 and 1910 federal censuses

The key household search should combine:

- Leon or Kirk Reynolds, born December 1889 in Nebraska.
- George W. Reynolds.
- Isabelle or Isabel Reynolds.
- Irene Reynolds.
- Arcadia or Valley County, Nebraska, followed by Portland, Oregon.

The 1900 census is especially valuable because it records month and year of birth, relationship to household head, parents' birthplaces, and years of marriage.

4. Retrieve Leon's World War I draft registration and service records

Search under Leon K., Leon Kirkwood, Kirk, and L. Kirk Reynolds in Multnomah County. The card may provide early employment, physical description, and nearest relative. Family testimony states that he served in France but did not see combat. Military personnel, unit, hospital, veterans', embarkation, and transport records should be searched for the branch, unit, rank, dates, and noncombat duties. [S33]

5. Examine the 1940 Honolulu census

Search for:

- Kirk Reynolds, approximately age 50, born Nebraska, FHA underwriter.
- Philomene Reynolds, approximately age 50.
- Daniel Reynolds, age seven or eight, born Oregon.
- Colonial Hotel, the Royal Hawaiian Hotel vicinity, and nearby enumeration districts containing government housing or bungalows.

The census should state their 1935 residence, which could reveal when the Hawaii transfer occurred.

6. Inspect the complete 1940 and 1941 Honolulu directories

Google Books supplies the 1940 snippet, while the Library of Congress telephone directory reel covers the critical interval. A page image can confirm the full alphabetical heading, telephone number, office address, and adjacent household information. Street and address sections should be reviewed for the government bungalow near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel. The non-searchable 1941 Polk-Husted directory should be inspected manually at the Reynolds pages. [S16, S17, S33]

7. Search passenger manifests and sailing records

Search San Francisco-Honolulu passenger arrivals and departures for Leon, Philomene, and Daniel Reynolds from approximately 1938 through 1942. Candidate records include passenger manifests, immigration and customs lists, newspaper sailing columns, steamship-company records, and port arrival notices. The highest-priority event is Philomene and Daniel's return shortly before December 7, 1941, followed by Leon's later return. [S33]

8. Search federal personnel, housing, and FHA records

Potential record groups include FHA territorial office directories, personnel rosters, annual reports, Federal Register notices, and National Archives records for the Portland and Honolulu offices. Personnel-transfer files, travel orders, payroll records, and government-housing assignments may identify the bungalow and Leon's exact Honolulu tenure.

9. Request cemetery and funeral-home records

Clackamas Cemetery may have lot cards, purchaser information, interment date, next-of-kin information, and a precise plot number. Finley's Morninglight Chapel records may survive in a funeral-home or archival collection. Funeral records could independently corroborate pneumonia, the fractured hip, Parkinson's disease, and the hospitalization sequence.

10. Search corporate and trade archives

Priority institutions:

- Equitable Savings and Loan Association.
- Oregon savings-and-loan association or league.
- First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland.
- Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan Association.
- Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco.

Annual reports, board minutes, employee newsletters, and trade-journal appointments could fill the 1942-1952 gap and settle the Benjamin Franklin question.

11. Obtain Philomene's 1988 death record and obituary

These may identify her parents, birthplace, siblings, surviving descendants, and the exact duration of her marriage to Leon. They may also document the Michigan-Spokane-Portland sequence, E. L. Barnes's sawmill and fire, and a fuller retrospective description of the Honolulu years.

23. Source catalog

S01. The Oregonian, June 12, 1963

Public archive search result and death-notice preview for "L. Kirk Reynolds." Establishes birth date and place, approximate arrival in Portland, occupation, death date and place, age, residence at Willamette Manor, and funeral announcement.

https://oregonlive.newsbank.com/search?date_from=01%2F01%2F1963&date_to=12%2F31%2F1963&text=%22Kirk%20Reynolds%22&pub%5B0%5D=11A73E5827618330

S02. Clackamas Cemetery transcription

Records Kirkwood Reynolds, 1889-1963, and Philomene B. Reynolds, 1889-1988, in the section described as "Left of Road."

<https://www.interment.net/data/us/or/clackamas/clackamas/clackamas.htm>

S03. Polk's Portland City Directory, 1920

Lists Leon K., George W. with wife Isabelle, and Irene H. Reynolds at 950 East Davis Street.

https://archive.org/details/CITY_DIRECTORY_PORTLAND_1920_2

S04. Sunday Oregonian, February 13, 1921

Engagement announcement for Philomene Barnes and Kirk Reynolds.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83045782/1921-02-13/ed-1/seq-45/>

S05. Morning Oregonian, March 4, 1921

Contemporary notice reporting the wedding date, time, place, families, and officiating minister.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83025138/1921-03-04/ed-1/seq-12/>

S06. Sunday Oregonian, March 6, 1921

Full society report of the wedding, including parents, Irene Reynolds, Maurice H. Barnes, Geraldine Coursen Barnes, and Madeline Stone.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83045782/1921-03-06/ed-1/seq-46/>

S07. Oregon marriage index

Records Leon K. Reynolds and Philomene M. Barnes, 1921, volume 51, page 230.

https://qfo.org/file_download/inline/dbd613c8-6974-4ff4-a13e-006bc1c3c6c3

S08. Oregonian society notices, 1907, 1913, and 1919

Potential pre-marriage Barnes-family and Leon-Philomene social references.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83045782/1919-08-17/ed-1/seq-56/>

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83045782/1913-08-03/ed-1/seq-37/>

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn83045782/1907-08-04/ed-1/seq-26/>

S09. Oregon Daily Journal, October 6, 1922

Lists Mrs. Kirk Reynolds among women assisting at a Portland tea.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn85042444/1922-10-06/ed-1/seq-12/>

S10. Klamath Falls Evening Herald, March 25, 1925

Brief business-visit notice for Kirk Reynolds of Portland.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn99063812/1925-03-25/ed-1/seq-4/>

S11. Roseburg News-Review, October 20, 1925

Identifies Kirk Reynolds as an Equitable Savings and Loan representative from Portland.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/2003260227/1925-10-20/ed-1/seq-6/>

S12. Medford Mail Tribune, October 24, 1925

Identifies Kirk Reynolds as inspector of loans for Equitable Savings and Loan Association.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn97071090/1925-10-24/ed-1/seq-2/>

S13. Oregon Statesman, October 9, 1932

Reports Kirk Reynolds and Ben Hazen returning from a statewide savings-and-loan meeting and advocating an operational Home Loan Bank in Portland.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn85042470/1932-10-09/ed-1/seq-5/>

S14. Oregon Statesman, February 7, 1933

Identifies Kirk Reynolds as executive secretary of the Oregon association of savings-and-loan organizations and explains his interest in Senate Bill 119.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn85042470/1933-02-07/ed-1/seq-5/>

S15. Oregon Statesman, March 1, 1935

Identifies Kirk Reynolds as acting chief underwriter for the FHA's Portland office and describes the Salem real-property survey.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn85042470/1935-03-01/ed-1/seq-2/>

S16. Polk-Husted Directory of Honolulu and the Territory of Hawaii, 1940

Page 533 search snippet lists Kirk in the Reynolds section as chief underwriter for the FHA, residing at the Colonial Hotel.

<https://books.google.com/books?id=x9MVAAAAIAAJ&pg=PA533>

S17. Library of Congress Honolulu telephone directories, 1938-1942

Telephone-directory compilation spanning the period of the family's Honolulu residence. The volume remains a target for complete manual review.

<https://www.loc.gov/item/usteledirec06699/>

S18. Housing and Home Finance Agency annual report for 1953

Page 147 lists Kirk Reynolds as a Class C director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco.

<https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/GOVPUB-HH-dbec50a5d627565fe50be6b1faf5b59d/pdf/GOVPUB-HH-dbec50a5d627565fe50be6b1faf5b59d.pdf>

S19. Eugene Register-Guard, March 21, 1955

Identifies Kirk Reynolds of Portland as a director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco and places him at its annual stockholders' meeting.

<https://oregonnews.uoregon.edu/lccn/sn85042472/1955-03-21/ed-1/seq-15/>

S20. Polk's Portland City Directory, 1956

Lists Kirk Reynolds, wife Philomene B., president of First Federal Savings and Loan Association of Portland, at 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue.

<https://archive.org/details/polksportlandcity1956porich>

S21. Polk's Portland City Directory, 1957

Lists Kirk and Philomene B. Reynolds at 3635 SW Beaverton Avenue.

<https://archive.org/details/polksportlandcity1957porich>

S22. Polk's Portland City Directory, 1959

Lists Kirk and Philomene at 2705 SE River Road, Milwaukie, and Daniel K. Reynolds as an appraiser for Benjamin Franklin Federal Savings and Loan.

<https://archive.org/details/polksportlandcity1959rich>

S23. Federal Home Loan Bank Board annual report

Contemporary institutional listing showing Benjamin Franklin, Equitable, and First Federal as separate Portland savings-and-loan institutions.

<https://fraser.stlouisfed.org/title/annual-report-federal-home-loan-bank-board-70/fourth-annual-report-federal-home-loan-bank-board-23514/fulltext>

S24. Congressional Record, April 4, 1973

Historical account of Benjamin Franklin Savings and Loan's organization and Ben Hazen's leadership.

<https://www.congress.gov/93/crecb/1973/04/04/GPO-CRECB-1973-pt9-2-2.pdf>

S25. Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds obituary

Confirms Leon and Philomene as Daniel's parents and supplies Daniel's education, marriage, children, military service, appraisal career, computer service, and personal interests.

<https://www.tributearchive.com/obituaries/35205486/daniel-kirkwood-reynolds>

S26. University of Oregon commencement program

Lists Daniel Kirkwood Reynolds of Portland as receiving a Bachelor of Business Administration degree.

<https://scholarsbank.uoregon.edu/bitstreams/d1e57197-6c56-4cf7-bb9d-924495fba5b1/download>

S27. Oregon State Archives vital-record guidance

Explains Oregon access restrictions and the process for requesting historical death records.

<https://sos.oregon.gov/archives/records/Pages/aids-vitalrecords.aspx>

S28. Valley County, Nebraska

Official county website confirming Arcadia as a Valley County community.

<https://valleycountyne.gov/>

S29. Nebraska State Gazetteer, 1890, Valley County

Lists Isabel Reynolds as Arcadia postmaster and W. B. Reynolds in real estate and insurance. This is a provisional family-history clue only.

<https://usgennet.org/usa/ne/topic/resources/NSHS/1890Gaz/vallybus.htm>

S30. Secondary Philomene Reynolds index

Provides provisional exact dates of September 5, 1889, and March 30, 1888. The dates require confirmation from an original or authoritative record.

<https://www.ancientfaces.com/directory/name/philip-reynolds/2>

S31. FamilySearch Oregon Death Index, 1903-1998

Authoritative index collection derived from the Oregon State Archives. Record searches require a free FamilySearch sign-in.

<https://www.familysearch.org/en/search/collection/1946790>

S32. Multnomah County Library newspaper resources

Describes library access to the Oregonian Collection with Historical Archives.

<https://multcolib.org/news-magazines>

S33. Reynolds family testimony, July 26, 2026

Direct-descendant recollections supplied for this report. The testimony states that Leon served in France during World War I without seeing combat; that the family lived in a government bungalow very near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel and traveled between San Francisco and Honolulu by passenger ship; that Philomene and Daniel returned to Portland shortly before Pearl Harbor while Leon remained in Honolulu; that Leon had Parkinson's disease and died from pneumonia in a Portland hospital after suffering a fractured hip; that Daniel was Leon and Philomene's only child; that Philomene's life proceeded from Michigan to Spokane to Portland; and that her father, E. L. Barnes, had a Spokane sawmill that burned down.

24. Overall assessment

Leon Kirkwood Reynolds was a Nebraska-born Portland housing-finance professional whose career developed alongside the modern American mortgage-finance system.

Beginning as a traveling loan inspector, he became a statewide savings-and-loan representative during the Depression, an early senior underwriter for the newly created Federal Housing Administration, an apparent territorial FHA chief underwriter in Honolulu, a director of the Federal Home Loan Bank of San Francisco, and president and manager of First Federal Savings and Loan in Portland.

The family account of Honolulu is strongly corroborated by the 1940 directory. The more detailed family testimony places the household in a government bungalow near the Royal Hawaiian Hotel, records passenger-ship travel through San Francisco, and establishes that Philomene and Daniel left before the Pearl Harbor attack while Leon remained in Honolulu. These details create specific, testable targets for passenger, housing, and federal-personnel records.

The family's recollection of Benjamin Franklin also has an identifiable documentary foundation through Leon's collaboration with Ben Hazen and Daniel's employment there, although Leon's precise direct relationship to that institution remains unresolved.

The most important next document is Leon's 1963 death certificate. It has the best chance of resolving his parents, the Arcadia household, his precise residence, and the remaining vital-record questions in a single authoritative source. It may also corroborate the family's recollection that pneumonia followed a fractured hip in the setting of Parkinson's disease.

This report should be treated as a living research document. Its established chronology is now strong, while its explicitly labeled clues provide a disciplined starting point for the next stage of family research.